

The key differences between MariaDB and MySQL

- MariaDB now has 12 new storage engines, whereas MySQL has fewer of these.
- MariaDB has a more significant connection pool, which can accommodate 200,000+ connections, whereas MySQL has a smaller pool.
- When comparing the performance of MariaDB with MySQL, replication in MariaDB is faster, but repetition in MySQL is slower.
- MariaDB is open source, but MySQL's Enterprise Edition includes some proprietary code.
- MariaDB does not allow data masking or dynamic columns, although MySQL does.
- When comparing MariaDB with MySQL, MariaDB outperforms MySQL.

When should MariaDB be used instead of MySQL?

While MariaDB has superior technical qualities over MySQL, don't base your decision just on this. Be aware of the differences in licence fees and levels of assistance, as these are significant success factors.

If you are comfortable dealing with problems independently, you will most likely profit more from MariaDB's technical benefits. On the other hand, if you want to be sure that you will receive timely assistance (and if you can afford it), a commercial MySQL installation is undoubtedly the best option for you.

Whatever database you choose, you should consider the key aspect — whether you need to integrate that data with other essential business data. It is easier to pull data from

MariaDB into other non-relational databases like MongoDB or Couch, and even Excel files. You can then save the data in a central area where everyone in your organisation can access it and query it, or examine the data using your existing BI or analytics tool.

MySQL is one of the world's largest commercial database vendor's corporate umbrella. There have already been some instances of forks, with many full-time engineers working around the clock to produce premium new features. When it comes to premium enhancements, MariaDB usually catches up, although this is not always immediate, and there are no promises.

MariaDB is undeniably powerful, with many capabilities that are incredibly helpful but not supported by MySQL. Such qualities make MariaDB an appealing alternative for use as the primary backend database. In general, enterprises that have previously obtained Oracle licences do not need to invest in MariaDB. However, for individuals who are starting from scratch and are unsure about which database to use, MariaDB is unquestionably a better option.

There are numerous cases in which MariaDB offers superior performance. Add to that the more agile patches and upgrades, a more reliable open source future, and a bit more optimism, and you can easily see why MariaDB is a vital and useful choice over MySQL for most users. **END** 

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